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In thinking about this week's assignment and today's information technology, electronic communication over the Internet or a local computer network is a very important issue for anyone who uses technology—for information sharing, the free or commercial use of software/hardware, and so on. This week's assignment underscores the responsibility of computer users, especially Internet users, regarding the importance of Netiquette. I thought I knew the rules of Netiquette, but many of the ethical, legal, and usage issues were raised from <http://www.albion.com/netiquette/>, which had never occurred to me before that I needed to pay special attention to things such as all caps, which implies that you are shouting. In addition, the article on plagiarism in the Chronicle of Higher Education echoes the responsibility of students and teachers regarding copyright and the privacy of information.

The core rules of Netiquette by Virginia Shea: I like her 10 core rules, but I think that there are many more to discover. One of the most important rules of netiquette is “think before you post”. Furthermore, I think it's a learned skill, and people can better educate themselves by reading information online, buying Virginia Shea's book, or training themselves in electronic communication. I have done a quick search on this topic, and there are many books on Netiquette. I think Netiquette continues to challenge educators because they never know what to expect, especially with the Internet and users' constantly changing behavior. Just as Virginia Shea has pointed out in her first rule, “Remember the Human”. I agree that we are only human and prone to making mistakes and misinterpreting other people's correspondence.

The article on plagiarism is good. There has to be a better way, and I am not sure as of right now, but I'll do some research on this topic. Generally, I don't like the idea of plagiarism-detection services. Foremost, I think that information technology is about information sharing, and having this kind of service undermines the meaning of information sharing and, in addition, violates students' rights under the Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act. Actually, there are many pending issues around Yahoo and Google search on this topic between government agencies and people's privacy, especially in third-world countries like China. However, I think there needs to be some kind of copyright law for the fair use of information. In addition, institutions of higher education have the right to enforce academic honesty.

I took the net quiz and got most of them right, but I am not proud of myself because I'm computer-savvy. Most of the questions are common sense about do or do not, but I have failed to answer a few questions, such as ALL CAP IMPLIED SHOUTING. I've always thought that it implies something important. I'm so wrong.

Today's information technology plays a central role in everyone's life, not just in businesses or institutions of higher education. For this reason, I think that technology users (especially educators) need to educate themselves on how to better practice netiquette, especially when technology is used for communication. Furthermore, I think this week's assignment has reminded us of our ethical standards, personal constructs, and electronic communication guidelines.